

Alcaraz and Kartal win on their return to tour tennis

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Carlos Alcaraz and Sonay Kartal both earned wins as they returned to tour **competition** after injuries. Alcaraz played in Japan, while Kartal played in China.

Alcaraz, the defending **champion** at the Japan Open, beat Alex Michelsen 7-6 (7-1) 4-6 6-1. He lost the second set but won the final set.

The Spanish world number three had spent just over five months away with a **wrist** injury. He returned at the US Open and reached the **quarter-finals**. Against Michelsen, he hit five aces but also made five **double faults**. A **double fault** means missing both chances to serve correctly, which loses the point.

In Beijing, Britain's Kartal beat Spain's Andrea Lazaro Garcia 6-2 6-3 at the China Open. It was her return to the WTA Tour after almost six months out with a lower-back injury.

Kartal had already returned to tennis at the Billie Jean King Cup on September 22. Now ranked 129th in the world, she will next face Wang Xinyu as she works to climb the **rankings** again.

Word Treasure

competition -- An event in which people try to win.

champion -- A player who has won a competition.

wrist -- The joint connecting your hand to your arm.

quarter-finals -- The round before the semi-finals.

double fault -- Two missed serves in a row that lose the point.

rankings -- A list showing players' positions based on their results.

Background you need

A double fault means a player misses both chances to serve correctly and loses the point.

Break it down

Introduces two players winning after injury breaks.

Reports Alcaraz's match result and earlier return.

Explains a double fault.

Reports Kartal's win, earlier return and next opponent.

Why it matters

The wins mark Alcaraz's and Kartal's return to tour competition after injuries kept them away for several months.

Test what you remember

1. Where did Alcaraz and Kartal play their tour matches?

- ☐ (A) China and Spain
- ☐ (B) Britain and Japan
- ☐ (C) Japan and China
- ☐ (D) Spain and Britain

2. Who did Alcaraz beat at the Japan Open?

- ☐ (A) Sonay Kartal
- ☐ (B) Wang Xinyu
- ☐ (C) Andrea Lazaro Garcia
- ☐ (D) Alex Michelsen

3. Which injury had kept Alcaraz away from tennis?

- ☐ (A) A lower-back injury
- ☐ (B) A wrist injury
- ☐ (C) A shoulder injury
- ☐ (D) An ankle injury

4. What happens when a player makes a double fault?

- ☐ (A) The player loses the point.
- ☐ (B) The players finish the set.
- ☐ (C) The player wins the point.
- ☐ (D) The players replay the point.

5. Where had Kartal already returned to tennis before Beijing?

- ☐ (A) The Japan Open
- ☐ (B) The Billie Jean King Cup
- ☐ (C) The China Open
- ☐ (D) The US Open

6. Who will Kartal face next?

- ☐ (A) Carlos Alcaraz
- ☐ (B) Wang Xinyu
- ☐ (C) Andrea Lazaro Garcia
- ☐ (D) Alex Michelsen

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: B 4: A 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):